

Outlook

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Follow-up: are we blocking the right cards for the right reasons?

Hi all,

I may be joining dots that do not belong together, so please challenge the premise.

Card blocking protects customers, but repeated legitimate attempts and later complaints may reveal controls that are too blunt. Several teams are reporting more failed or retried activity than they expected, but they do not agree on the cause. The first extracts did not reconcile, which means source precedence and exclusions must be part of the answer.

Could the answer be that ordinary PIN errors create avoidable blocks? Or are we actually seeing that customers receive inconsistent recovery paths? I also do not want us to miss the possibility that blocked cards follow genuinely unusual sequences.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use October 2021 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The practical decision is where thresholds, escalation or customer communication should change. Please send a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review; I need the exceptions and counter-examples, not only an average.

Work from ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. Do not label a block as incorrect without the rule decision and investigation outcome.

Regards